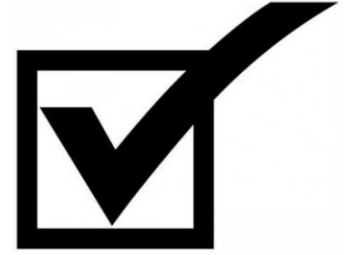




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS
of AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS AND PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2024

PRELIMINARY

Presentation Points _____ **(140 points)**

Specification Points _____ **(20 points)**

TOTAL POINTS _____ **(160 points)**

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestants must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

STATE PRELIMINARY SCENARIO:

You are the social media marketing manager for Digital Solutions. Your responsibilities are to manage the organization's social media content by responding to all customers' questions, comments, and complaints and posting information about Digital Solutions' products and services. You notice Brandon, a regular customer of Digital Solutions, posting negative comments about Digital Solutions with comments that you believe to be unfair. You are not a fan of Brandon's because he is never satisfied and always takes to social media to publicly complain so you decide to ignore him since nothing you say will satisfy him. Over the next few days, the complaints got worse and the negative posts are more frequent. Your boss notices this and calls you into her office for an explanation.

- How do you prepare for the meeting and what will you say in your defense?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Professionalism allows for heightened respect from clients, thereby, opening greater lines of communication and potentially increasing trust. A company known for maintaining a level of high ethical and professional standards is typically valued above its peers when competing in the same market.
- Paying respect to co-workers, oneself, and clients, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional.
- Professionalism plays an important role in how a person is perceived by his/her employer, his/her co-workers, and casual contacts.
- Today's employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.

- Learning how to confidently interact with colleagues, clients, and customers in a professional manner is vital for future success.